

PROBLEMS AND ALTERNATIVES

Problem: Too many housing options with no clear way to compare them
Alternative: Manually comparing listings across multiple housing websites

Problem: Unsafe interactions with unknown landlords and potential roommates
Alternative: Verifying people informally through social media profiles

Problem: Misleading or exaggerated expectations from leasing offices
Alternative: Visiting properties in person before signing a lease

Problem: Limited and fragmented ways to discover potential roommates
Alternative: Using Facebook groups organized by graduation year

Problem: High exposure to scams and deceptive online behavior
Alternative: Restricting searches to well-known rental platforms with limited visibility and filters

Problem: Lack of reliable information about surrounding neighborhoods near campus
Alternative: Searching for opinions on Reddit or local forums

Problem: Difficulty finding roommates with compatible lifestyles, values, and budgets
Alternative: Conducting informal interviews through chat or video calls

Problem: High application fees that limit how many places students can apply to
Alternative: Applying only to one or two “safe” housing options

Problem: Complex and confusing contract and payment logistics
Alternative: Handling contracts and payments manually via email and bank transfers

Problem: Difficulty adapting to a new city without an existing social network
Alternative: Relying on classmates as the primary source of guidance

Problem: No reliable way to assess roommate reliability and long-term commitment
Alternative: Making decisions based on personal impressions and trust

Problem: Low transparency about real living conditions before signing a lease
Alternative: Manually requesting photos/videos directly from landlord

SOLUTIONS

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